

DSAT Practice — Cross-Text (Paired Passages)

25 Original MCQs | Questions Only

Q1.

[Easy]

Text 1

Historian David Owusu has argued that the rapid expansion of railway networks in nineteenth-century West Africa primarily served the economic interests of colonial powers, enabling the efficient extraction of natural resources such as cocoa and minerals for export to European markets.

Text 2

While acknowledging the exploitative origins of West African railways, economic geographer Fatima Diallo contends that these networks also facilitated the growth of internal trade among West African communities. Market towns along rail corridors experienced population growth and economic diversification that persisted long after independence.

Based on the texts, how would Diallo (Text 2) most likely respond to Owusu's characterization of West African railways in Text 1?

- A) By arguing that Owusu has overlooked the railways' lasting benefits for local West African economies.
 - B) By disputing Owusu's claim that colonial powers had any economic motivation for building railways.
 - C) By suggesting that Owusu's research relies on outdated sources that have since been discredited.
 - D) By asserting that the railways were constructed primarily by West African workers, not colonial administrators.
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Q2.

[Easy]

Text 1

Psychologist Leon Whitfield argues that handwriting instruction remains essential in elementary education. Studies show that the motor act of forming letters by hand activates brain regions associated with reading comprehension and memory retention in ways that typing does not.

Text 2

Education researcher Mei-Lin Zhao points out that digital literacy skills are increasingly prerequisite for academic and professional success. Given limited instructional time, Zhao argues, schools should prioritize keyboarding proficiency over extensive handwriting practice, since students will spend the vast majority of their academic and professional lives composing text on screens.

Based on the texts, the authors of Text 1 and Text 2 would most likely disagree about which of the following?

- A) Whether digital literacy is relevant to professional success.
 - B) Whether handwriting instruction or keyboarding instruction should receive more emphasis in elementary school curricula.
 - C) Whether motor activity can influence cognitive development in children.
 - D) Whether elementary schools currently devote sufficient time to language arts instruction overall.
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Q3.

[Easy]

Text 1

Botanist Julia Tran has documented that urban gardens in temperate climates support a surprising diversity of native bee species. Her surveys of 60 community gardens across three cities found an average of 24 native bee species per site, suggesting that small green spaces can serve as meaningful pollinator refuges.

Text 2

Entomologist Ravi Subramanian cautions that species counts alone may overstate the ecological value of urban gardens. Many of the native bee species found in these settings are habitat generalists—species that thrive in many environments—while the specialist species most at risk of decline are largely absent from urban gardens.

Based on the texts, how would Subramanian (Text 2) most likely respond to Tran's conclusion about urban gardens in Text 1?

- A) By arguing that Tran's surveys were conducted in too few cities to produce reliable data.
 - B) By suggesting that Tran's species counts may not reflect the gardens' value for the bee species most in need of conservation.
 - C) By claiming that native bee species are less effective pollinators than non-native species in urban environments.
 - D) By asserting that community gardens are ecologically valuable for reasons unrelated to pollinator diversity.
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Q4.

[Easy]

Text 1

Archaeologists have long believed that the earliest inhabitants of the Canary Islands arrived from the North African mainland by sea around 100 BCE. This timeline is based on radiocarbon dating of organic materials recovered from the oldest known settlement sites.

Text 2

Genetic analyses of modern Canary Islanders indicate that the founding population's closest genetic relatives are the Amazigh peoples of northwestern Africa. Molecular clock estimates based on these genetic data suggest that the migration to the Canary Islands may have occurred as early as 500 BCE, several centuries before the date suggested by the archaeological record alone.

Based on the texts, what is the relationship between the archaeological evidence discussed in Text 1 and the genetic evidence discussed in Text 2?

- A) The genetic evidence contradicts the archaeological evidence regarding the geographic origin of the first settlers.
 - B) The genetic evidence suggests an earlier date of migration than the archaeological evidence does.
 - C) The archaeological evidence is based on a broader range of data sources than the genetic evidence is.
 - D) The archaeological evidence has been shown to be unreliable, while the genetic evidence is considered definitive.
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Q5.

[Easy]

Text 1

Political theorist Amara Osei contends that compulsory voting—requiring all eligible citizens to cast ballots under penalty of a small fine—would increase democratic legitimacy by ensuring that election outcomes reflect the preferences of the entire electorate rather than only those motivated enough to vote voluntarily.

Text 2

Philosopher Nikolai Petrov argues that compelling citizens to vote undermines the very freedom that democratic governance is meant to protect. In Petrov's view, the right to vote inherently includes the right not to vote, and penalizing abstention transforms a civic privilege into a coercive obligation.

Based on the texts, Osei and Petrov would most likely disagree about which of the following?

- A) Whether voter turnout rates have declined in recent decades.
 - B) Whether democratic governments should hold regular elections.
 - C) Whether eligible citizens currently have the legal right to vote in most democracies.
 - D) Whether requiring citizens to vote would be a desirable policy for democratic societies.
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Q6.

[Easy]

Text 1

Linguist Hannah Bergström has found that bilingual children who learn both languages from birth tend to develop strong proficiency in each language by age five, suggesting that simultaneous bilingual exposure does not impede language development.

Text 2

Developmental psychologist Carlos Rivera notes that bilingual children sometimes lag behind monolingual peers in vocabulary size within each individual language during the early years, even though their total vocabulary across both languages is comparable to that of monolingual children. Rivera emphasizes that this early lag is temporary and typically disappears by school age.

Based on the texts, the author of Text 1 would most likely agree with which statement about the temporary vocabulary lag described in Text 2?

- A) It does not indicate that bilingual exposure is ultimately harmful to children's language development.
 - B) It has not been documented in any well-designed study.
 - C) It is likely caused by insufficient exposure to one of the two languages at home.
 - D) It demonstrates that monolingual education produces better outcomes than bilingual education.
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Q7.

[Easy]

Text 1

Astronomer Kenji Mori argues that the search for extraterrestrial intelligence (SETI) should focus on detecting laser-based optical signals rather than traditional radio waves. Laser signals, Mori notes, can carry far more information per second and are easier to distinguish from natural astrophysical phenomena.

Text 2

Astronomer Celeste Duval counters that radio-wave detection remains the most practical approach for SETI. Radio telescopes are widely available, relatively inexpensive to operate, and have already amassed decades of archived data that can be reanalyzed with improving algorithms.

Based on the texts, which statement best characterizes the relationship between Mori's position (Text 1) and Duval's position (Text 2)?

- A) They disagree about whether extraterrestrial intelligence is likely to exist.
 - B) They disagree about which signal type should be prioritized in the search for extraterrestrial intelligence.
 - C) Duval provides evidence that directly refutes Mori's claims about the advantages of laser signals.
 - D) Mori and Duval both advocate for using optical signals but disagree about the timeline for implementation.
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Q8.

[Easy]

Text 1

Economist Irene Walters has observed that nations with higher rates of broadband internet access tend to experience faster GDP growth, a correlation she attributes to the productivity gains that high-speed connectivity enables across multiple economic sectors.

Text 2

Development scholar Oumar Sy cautions that the relationship between broadband access and economic growth may be partly reverse-causal: wealthier nations can afford to invest more in internet infrastructure, so GDP growth may drive broadband expansion as much as broadband expansion drives GDP growth.

Based on the texts, how would Sy (Text 2) most likely respond to Walters's argument in Text 1?

- A) By suggesting that Walters has underestimated the cost of broadband infrastructure.
 - B) By arguing that GDP is not a useful measure of economic health.
 - C) By claiming that broadband internet has no measurable effect on productivity.
 - D) By pointing out that Walters may have the direction of causation partly reversed.
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Q9.

[Medium]

Text 1

Neuroscientist Adeline Park proposes that the brain's default mode network (DMN)—a set of interconnected brain regions active during rest and mind-wandering—plays a central role in creative ideation. Park points to neuroimaging studies showing that artists and writers exhibit heightened DMN activity during brainstorming tasks.

Text 2

Cognitive psychologist Tomás Ruiz argues that creativity cannot be attributed to any single neural network. In Ruiz's view, creative thought requires dynamic interplay between the DMN and the executive control network (ECN), which governs focused attention and evaluation. Without ECN involvement, Ruiz contends, the unconstrained associations generated by the DMN would rarely yield coherent or useful ideas.

Based on the texts, how would Ruiz (Text 2) most likely respond to Park's proposal in Text 1?

- A) By claiming that the default mode network is not active during rest and mind-wandering.
 - B) By disputing the validity of the neuroimaging studies that Park cites as evidence for her proposal.
 - C) By arguing that Park's model overemphasizes one neural network and neglects the contribution of another network that is essential for refining creative output.
 - D) By asserting that artists and writers do not exhibit higher levels of creativity than the general population.
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Q10.

[Medium]

Text 1

Historian Leila Abbas has argued that the decline of the Ottoman Empire in the nineteenth century was driven primarily by internal administrative dysfunction, including corruption, bureaucratic inertia, and the failure to modernize tax collection systems.

Text 2

Historian Marcus Brennan contends that internal factors alone cannot explain the Ottoman decline. Brennan emphasizes the role of external pressures—particularly the economic penetration of European industrial powers, whose cheap manufactured goods flooded Ottoman markets and undermined local artisans—in accelerating the empire's economic deterioration.

Based on the texts, which choice best describes the relationship between Abbas's argument (Text 1) and Brennan's argument (Text 2)?

- A) Abbas provides a broader analysis than Brennan, who focuses narrowly on a single economic factor.
 - B) Brennan and Abbas focus on the same set of causes but reach different conclusions about which was most damaging.
 - C) Brennan acknowledges the factors Abbas identifies but argues that additional factors were also significant.
 - D) Abbas and Brennan agree on the causes of Ottoman decline but disagree about when the decline began.
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Q11.

[Medium]

Text 1

Literary critic Josephine Lam has observed that contemporary novels increasingly employ fragmented narrative structures—multiple timelines, shifting perspectives, and nonlinear plotting—to mirror the disjointed nature of modern digital experience.

Text 2

Novelist and essayist Raymond Udo argues that fragmented narrative structures predate the digital age by more than a century, pointing to works like Laurence Sterne's *Tristram Shandy* (1759). While Udo acknowledges that digital culture may have popularized such techniques among a wider readership, he maintains that attributing their rise to technology oversimplifies a complex literary tradition.

Based on the texts, how would Udo (Text 2) most likely respond to Lam's observation in Text 1?

- A) By agreeing with Lam that digital experience is the primary driver of innovation in contemporary fiction.
 - B) By claiming that Lam has incorrectly defined what constitutes a fragmented narrative structure.
 - C) By asserting that contemporary novels are less likely to employ fragmented structures than novels from earlier periods.
 - D) By arguing that Lam has overstated the role of digital culture in the development of fragmented narrative, given the technique's long literary history.
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Q12.

[Medium]

Text 1

Material scientist Akiko Tanaka has demonstrated that aerogels—extremely lightweight, porous solid materials—can be manufactured from recycled cellulose fibers, potentially offering an environmentally sustainable alternative to petroleum-based insulation products. Tanaka's cellulose aerogels achieved thermal conductivity values comparable to conventional foam insulation.

Text 2

Engineer Dmitri Volkov notes that while cellulose-based aerogels show promise in laboratory settings, their mechanical fragility poses a significant obstacle to commercial use. In compression tests, Volkov found that cellulose aerogels crumbled under loads that conventional foam insulation routinely withstands, raising doubts about their practical durability in building applications.

Based on the texts, the author of Text 1 and the author of Text 2 would most likely agree on which of the following points?

- A) Petroleum-based insulation products should no longer be used in new construction.
 - B) Cellulose aerogels are ready for immediate commercial deployment in the construction industry.
 - C) The mechanical properties of cellulose aerogels are their most important characteristic.
 - D) Cellulose aerogels can achieve thermal performance similar to that of conventional insulation.
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Q13.

[Medium]

Text 1

Ecologist Sana Khoury has documented that artificial night lighting in coastal areas disorients sea turtle hatchlings, which rely on the natural luminance of the ocean horizon to navigate toward the sea. In heavily lit areas, hatchlings often crawl inland toward artificial light sources and perish from dehydration or predation.

Text 2

Conservation technologist Emeka Obi has developed amber-wavelength LED streetlights designed to reduce disorientation in sea turtle hatchlings. Obi's laboratory tests show that hatchlings exposed to amber light exhibit significantly less misdirected movement than those exposed to standard white LED light. Obi acknowledges, however, that field trials are needed to confirm these results under natural conditions.

Based on the texts, how would the author of Text 1 most likely view the technology described in Text 2?

- A) As a technology that addresses a different species of marine animal than the one discussed in Text 1.
 - B) As an unnecessary solution, since the problem described in Text 1 has already been resolved through other means.
 - C) As a potentially useful intervention for mitigating the problem identified in Text 1, pending confirmation in real-world settings.
 - D) As likely to worsen the problem described in Text 1 by introducing a new type of light pollution.
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Q14.

[Medium]

Text 1

Sociologist Rebecca Thorn contends that the rise of remote work has weakened what she calls 'ambient mentorship'—the informal, unplanned learning that occurs when junior employees observe and interact with experienced colleagues in shared physical spaces. Without these spontaneous encounters, Thorn argues, professional development suffers.

Text 2

Organizational psychologist James Yoon reports that companies implementing structured virtual mentorship programs—featuring regular one-on-one video sessions and collaborative online projects—have seen mentee satisfaction rates comparable to those achieved through traditional in-person mentorship. Yoon suggests that deliberate program design can compensate for the loss of casual workplace interaction.

Based on the texts, how would Yoon (Text 2) most likely respond to Thorn's concern about remote work in Text 1?

- A) By claiming that in-person mentorship was never effective in the first place.
 - B) By arguing that professional development is not actually affected by the shift to remote work.
 - C) By suggesting that intentional virtual mentorship programs can replace the informal learning opportunities that remote work eliminates.
 - D) By asserting that remote work has increased the amount of time available for formal professional training.
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Q15.

[Medium]

Text 1

Physicist Yara Hamdi has proposed that dark matter—the invisible substance thought to constitute roughly 27% of the universe's mass-energy content—may consist of primordial black holes formed in the moments after the Big Bang, rather than the exotic subatomic particles favored by most theoretical models.

Text 2

Astrophysicist Connor Blake notes that if primordial black holes accounted for all dark matter, their gravitational effects would produce observable distortions in the light of distant stars through a phenomenon called microlensing. Extensive surveys designed to detect such distortions have found far fewer microlensing events than the primordial black hole hypothesis predicts, suggesting that these objects can compose, at most, a small fraction of dark matter.

Based on the texts, how would Blake (Text 2) most likely evaluate Hamdi's proposal in Text 1?

- A) By arguing that observational evidence suggests primordial black holes cannot account for all dark matter, as Hamdi proposes.
 - B) By agreeing that primordial black holes are the most promising candidate for dark matter.
 - C) By asserting that the microlensing phenomenon is irrelevant to evaluating dark matter hypotheses.
 - D) By claiming that Hamdi's proposal is based on a misunderstanding of the Big Bang's physics.
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Q16.

[Medium]

Text 1

Architect Simone Leclaire advocates for the widespread adoption of mass timber construction—using engineered wood products such as cross-laminated timber (CLT) for the structural frames of mid-rise and tall buildings. Leclaire argues that mass timber sequesters atmospheric carbon, reduces construction waste, and is renewable, making it a more sustainable alternative to steel and concrete.

Text 2

Structural engineer Hassan Malek cautions that mass timber's fire performance remains a concern despite advances in fire-retardant treatments. Building codes in most countries still restrict timber-framed buildings to lower heights than steel or concrete structures, reflecting ongoing uncertainty about how mass timber behaves during prolonged, high-intensity fires.

Based on the texts, the author of Text 1 would most likely respond to the concern raised in Text 2 by making which of the following arguments?

- A) Fire-retardant treatments have already been proven to eliminate all fire risk in mass timber buildings.
- B) Building codes should not restrict the height of any type of structure.
- C) Steel and concrete structures are just as vulnerable to fire as mass timber structures.
- D) The sustainability advantages of mass timber are significant enough to justify continued research into improving its fire performance.

Q17.

[Medium]

Text 1

Museums have traditionally displayed artifacts behind glass with minimal contextual information, an approach art historian Lucinda Vaz criticizes as 'decontextualized spectacle.' Vaz argues that without narrative context—information about who made an object, how it was used, and what cultural values it embodied—visitors engage with artifacts superficially, appreciating their aesthetic qualities while remaining ignorant of their historical significance.

Text 2

Curator Darian Cole maintains that too much contextual information can overwhelm visitors and diminish the aesthetic experience that draws people to museums in the first place. Cole advocates for a balanced approach in which a small number of carefully chosen details supplement, rather than replace, the visitor's direct encounter with the object.

Based on the texts, which choice best describes the relationship between the positions of Vaz (Text 1) and Cole (Text 2)?

- A) Vaz argues for more context while Cole argues for eliminating context entirely.
 - B) Both advocate for providing context alongside artifacts, but they disagree about how much context is appropriate.
 - C) Both oppose the traditional approach to museum display, but for entirely different reasons.
 - D) Vaz focuses on visitor education while Cole is concerned exclusively with an institution's financial viability.
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Q18.

[Medium]

Text 1

Epidemiologist Lucia Fonseca has shown that communities with higher rates of green space access—parks, gardens, and tree-lined streets—tend to report lower levels of chronic stress. Fonseca attributes this association to the restorative effects of natural environments, which have been shown to reduce cortisol levels and lower heart rate.

Text 2

Urban planner Derek Huang argues that the correlation between green space and reduced stress may be confounded by socioeconomic factors. Wealthier communities, Huang notes, tend to have both more green space and better access to healthcare, nutritious food, and safe housing—all of which independently contribute to lower stress levels.

Based on the texts, how would Huang (Text 2) most likely respond to Fonseca's conclusion in Text 1?

- A) By suggesting that Fonseca's conclusion may not adequately account for other variables associated with both green space access and stress levels.
- B) By disputing the scientific evidence that natural environments can reduce cortisol levels.
- C) By arguing that communities should invest in healthcare rather than parks.
- D) By claiming that wealthier communities do not actually have more green space than lower-income communities.

Q19.

[Hard]

Text 1

Literary scholar Patricia Mendez argues that the unreliable narrator—a storytelling device in which the narrator's account is revealed to be distorted by bias, ignorance, or deception—functions primarily as a tool of psychological realism. By forcing readers to question the narrator's perspective, Mendez contends, the device mirrors the way people in real life must constantly evaluate the reliability of others' accounts.

Text 2

Narratologist Kwesi Appiah maintains that the unreliable narrator serves a fundamentally metafictional purpose: it foregrounds the constructed nature of all storytelling. When readers recognize a narrator's unreliability, Appiah argues, they become aware of the artifice inherent in narrative itself, prompting them to reflect not only on the narrator's biases but also on the conventions and assumptions that shape every act of narration.

Based on the texts, how would Appiah (Text 2) most likely respond to Mendez's characterization of the unreliable narrator in Text 1?

- A) By asserting that readers rarely notice when a narrator is unreliable, rendering Mendez's analysis irrelevant.
 - B) By agreeing with Mendez that the unreliable narrator is primarily a tool of psychological realism, while adding that it also has secondary aesthetic effects.
 - C) By claiming that Mendez has confused the unreliable narrator with a different literary technique.
 - D) By arguing that Mendez's emphasis on psychological realism understates the device's capacity to make readers critically aware of the nature of storytelling itself.
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Q20.

[Hard]

Text 1

Climatologist Ingrid Solberg has proposed that stratospheric aerosol injection (SAI)—a geoengineering technique that would involve dispersing reflective particles in the upper atmosphere to reduce incoming solar radiation—could serve as a temporary measure to slow global warming while long-term decarbonization efforts proceed. Solberg emphasizes that SAI would not address the root cause of climate change but could buy critical time.

Text 2

Environmental ethicist Kwame Mensah objects that SAI creates a 'moral hazard': by offering the appearance of a quick fix, it may reduce political urgency to cut greenhouse gas emissions. Furthermore, Mensah warns, if SAI were ever abruptly halted—due to geopolitical conflict or technical failure—the suppressed warming would return rapidly, potentially causing more severe climate disruption than would have occurred without the intervention.

Based on the texts, which choice best describes how Mensah's argument in Text 2 relates to Solberg's proposal in Text 1?

- A) Mensah disputes Solberg's claim that SAI would effectively reduce incoming solar radiation.
 - B) Mensah raises both a political and a physical risk that he believes undermine the viability of the approach Solberg advocates.
 - C) Mensah and Solberg disagree about whether greenhouse gas emissions are the primary cause of global warming.
 - D) Mensah supports SAI in principle but argues that its implementation should be delayed until decarbonization is further along.
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Q21.*[Hard]*

Text 1

Philosopher Dara Okonjo has argued that artificial intelligence systems should not be described as 'creative,' even when they produce novel outputs such as paintings or musical compositions. True creativity, Okonjo contends, requires intentionality—the capacity to envision a goal and pursue it through deliberate choices—and current AI systems lack this capacity, operating instead through sophisticated pattern recognition on training data.

Text 2

Computational artist Felix Brandt counters that defining creativity in terms of intentionality privileges a narrowly human conception of the creative process. Brandt points out that many human creative breakthroughs arise not from deliberate planning but from accidental combinations and unconscious associations—processes that, he argues, are functionally analogous to the stochastic recombination of patterns that characterizes AI-generated art.

Based on the texts, which choice best characterizes the core disagreement between Okonjo (Text 1) and Brandt (Text 2)?

- A) They disagree about whether human artists rely on pattern recognition.
 - B) They disagree about whether AI systems can produce outputs that are novel.
 - C) They disagree about whether intentionality is a necessary component of creativity.
 - D) They disagree about whether AI-generated art should be exhibited in galleries.
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Q22.*[Hard]*

Text 1

Ecologist Mariana Costa has proposed the 'landscape of fear' hypothesis, which holds that the mere presence of predators in an ecosystem shapes prey behavior in ways that have cascading effects on vegetation. Prey animals that perceive predation risk, Costa argues, avoid certain areas, allowing plants in those areas to recover from overgrazing.

Text 2

Ecologist Jakob Lindqvist tested the landscape of fear hypothesis in a grassland ecosystem from which wolves had been absent for thirty years and were recently reintroduced. Contrary to the hypothesis's predictions, Lindqvist found no significant difference in elk grazing patterns or vegetation density between areas with high and low wolf activity. He attributes this result to the possibility that elk in this ecosystem had lost their antipredator behavioral responses during the long period without wolves and had not yet re-developed them.

Based on the texts, how would Costa (Text 1) most likely respond to Lindqvist's findings in Text 2?

- A) By arguing that the absence of the predicted behavioral changes does not refute the hypothesis, since the elk population studied may not have had sufficient time to reestablish antipredator responses.
 - B) By conceding that the hypothesis is invalid and should be replaced by an alternative ecological model.
 - C) By claiming that Lindqvist's study was too short in duration to detect any ecological changes.
 - D) By asserting that wolves are not effective apex predators in grassland ecosystems.
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Q23.

[Hard]

Text 1

Sociologist Petra Lang has documented a pattern she calls 'credential inflation,' in which occupations that previously required only a high school diploma now demand a bachelor's degree, even when the actual skills needed for the job have not changed. Lang argues that this trend disadvantages workers from lower socioeconomic backgrounds who face financial barriers to higher education.

Text 2

Labor economist Raj Chaturvedi acknowledges that credential requirements have risen but argues that this reflects genuine changes in workplace demands. As industries adopt more complex technologies, Chaturvedi contends, workers need the analytical and communication skills that higher education cultivates—skills that may not be apparent from a job description alone but are nonetheless essential for effective performance.

Based on the texts, which choice best describes the fundamental difference between Lang's and Chaturvedi's interpretations of rising credential requirements?

- A) Lang views the trend as a gatekeeping mechanism unrelated to actual job demands, while Chaturvedi views it as a reasonable response to genuinely increased skill requirements.
 - B) Lang attributes the trend to employer preferences, while Chaturvedi attributes it to government regulation.
 - C) Lang believes the trend affects all occupations equally, while Chaturvedi argues it is limited to technology-related fields.
 - D) Lang focuses on the trend's effects on workers, while Chaturvedi focuses on its effects on employers' hiring costs.
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Q24.

[Hard]

Text 1

In a 2022 study, psychologist Elena Varga found that participants who were asked to recall a past act of generosity subsequently reported higher levels of life satisfaction than participants in a control group. Varga interpreted this finding as evidence that reflecting on prosocial behavior activates a positive self-concept, which in turn elevates subjective well-being.

Text 2

Psychologist Andre Muller replicated Varga's protocol but added physiological measures of emotional arousal. While Muller confirmed that participants who recalled generous acts reported higher satisfaction, he found no corresponding increase in physiological arousal (measured by skin conductance and heart rate). Muller suggests that the self-reported satisfaction increase may reflect social desirability bias—participants reporting what they believe the researchers expect—rather than a genuine shift in well-being.

Based on the texts, how would Muller (Text 2) most likely characterize Varga's interpretation of her findings in Text 1?

- A) As supported by Muller's own data, which confirmed both the self-report and physiological components of Varga's findings.
 - B) As potentially reflecting participants' desire to appear consistent with social expectations rather than capturing an actual change in well-being.
 - C) As based on a sample size too small to produce statistically meaningful results.
 - D) As irrelevant to the broader question of whether prosocial behavior affects psychological outcomes.
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Q25.

[Hard]

Text 1

Linguist Sofia Herrera argues that the global spread of English as a lingua franca is enriching, not impoverishing, the world's linguistic landscape. As speakers in different regions adapt English to local phonological and grammatical patterns, Herrera contends, they create new varieties—such as Singlish and Nigerian Pidgin—that function as distinct linguistic systems worthy of scholarly study.

Text 2

Sociolinguist Kofi Adjei counters that the proliferation of English varieties cannot compensate for the loss of indigenous languages that occurs when communities shift to English for economic advancement. Adjei points out that approximately one language goes extinct every two weeks, and that the social prestige of English accelerates this process by discouraging younger generations from learning their ancestral languages.

Based on the texts, which choice best describes the relationship between Herrera's argument (Text 1) and Adjei's argument (Text 2)?

- A) Herrera argues that English should replace indigenous languages, while Adjei argues that indigenous languages should replace English.
 - B) Both authors agree that indigenous languages are declining but disagree about the rate of that decline.
 - C) Herrera focuses on the new linguistic diversity created by English's spread, while Adjei focuses on the existing linguistic diversity that English's spread threatens to eliminate.
 - D) Adjei provides historical evidence that directly contradicts Herrera's claims about the emergence of new English varieties.
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